It nearly did. After he read it, he told me I would have to make changes to reduce the similarity, and he said it regretfully for he thought mine was the better story. I objected that the changes he asked for would kill the point of the story, but he insisted.

On the way back to Somerville on December 4, Gertrude, who had become so involved in my stories that she wanted to know as much as she could, asked me where I got my ideas.

"Anywhere," I said. "I could write a story about a trip from Boston to New York, for instance."

I thought about it for a while, told her the plot that occurred to

me, and the next evening began to write a story I called "What if—?" It was actually an Unknown story, a tale of alternate time-paths revealed by a supernatural figure, but I did my best to make it sound science-fictiony. I completed it in two weeks. 1

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On December 12, I ate my first pizza and found it delightful.

At about that time, too, The Stars, like Dust— began running as a three-part serial in Galaxy, under the absolutely silly title of "Tyrann." (Gold was a good editor, but his taste in titles was execrable.) The first part made the cover in the January 1951 Galaxy.

I completed my education in driving now by finding ample opportunity to make my way through ice and snow. On December 15, when I was approaching a friend's home far out in the suburbs, I found myself caught on icy roads. I made it, but it was a frightening experience.

Then, on December 26, I found that I had to get back from school in falling snow and a thick layer on the ground. I was very uneasy about it. Mrs. Walker, who worked at the school, teaching chemistry to student nurses, volunteered to come with me. This was courage above and beyond the call of duty on her part. I got home safely, but the added security of having her in the car to advise and help if that were necessary was, I'm sure, what made it possible.

And meanwhile, I had begun a new novel, The Currents of Space.